KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

Country-by-Country Travel Reference

10 Countries · 4 Data Domains per Country · Full Detail
Visa Requirements · Emergency Contacts · Dos & Don'ts · Health Advisories
March 2026

#	Country	Code	Region	Capital
1	🇷🇼 Rwanda	**RW**	East Africa	Kigali
2	🇰🇪 Kenya	**KE**	East Africa	Nairobi
3	🇹🇿 Tanzania	**TZ**	East Africa	Dodoma (commercial: Dar es Salaam)
4	🇺🇬 Uganda	**UG**	East Africa	Kampala
5	🇳🇬 Nigeria	**NG**	West Africa	Abuja
6	🇬🇭 Ghana	**GH**	West Africa	Accra
7	🇿🇦 South Africa	**ZA**	Southern Africa	Pretoria (Cape Town: legislative)
8	🇲🇦 Morocco	**MA**	North Africa	Rabat
9	🇪🇹 Ethiopia	**ET**	East Africa	Addis Ababa
10	🇸🇳 Senegal	**SN**	West Africa	Dakar

🇷🇼 RWANDA (RW)

East Africa · Capital: Kigali

🛂 VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — for most nationalities
Visa Type	eVisa (online) or Visa on Arrival
eVisa Portal	https://irembo.gov.rw/rolportal/en/web/minema/e-visa
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	30 days (extendable to 90 days)
Visa-Free Access	Citizens of East African Community (Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Burundi, South Sudan) enter visa-free
Entry Rules	Return/onward ticket required. Yellow Fever certificate required if arriving from endemic country.
Visa Duration	30 days on arrival; eVisa up to 90 days
Cost	USD 50 single entry / USD 70 multiple entry
Processing Time	eVisa approved within 72 hours
Official Source	https://irembo.gov.rw

🚨 EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
112	**912**	**111**	**112**	**(+250) 788 311 155**

Tourist Police	(+250) 788 311 155
US Embassy	(+250) 252 596 400
UK Embassy	(+250) 252 556 000
Notes	112 is the universal emergency number. Tourist police are active in Kigali city centre.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Carry your national ID or passport at all times — police checks are common
- Participate respectfully in Umuganda (community work) on the last Saturday of each month — roads close 8am–11am
- Dress modestly, especially outside Kigali and when visiting churches or rural communities
- Greet elders with both hands when shaking — a sign of deep respect
- Ask permission before photographing people, especially in rural areas
- Use designated bins — Rwanda is one of Africa's cleanest countries and takes littering seriously

- Carry small cash (Rwandan Franc) — not all vendors accept cards

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT bring plastic bags — banned at all entry points including the airport
- Do NOT photograph military installations, government buildings, or border posts
- Do NOT litter — fines are strictly enforced and can be significant
- Do NOT discuss the 1994 genocide insensitively — it is a deeply sensitive national topic
- Do NOT buy or sell wildlife products — Rwanda strictly enforces conservation laws
- Do NOT use your left hand alone to give or receive items — considered impolite
- Do NOT assume all roads are open during Umuganda morning hours

Dress Code	Smart casual is acceptable in Kigali. Modest dress (covered shoulders and knees) required in rural areas, churches, and government offices. Beachwear only at lakeside resorts.
Photography Rules	Always ask permission before photographing individuals. Military areas, border crossings, government buildings, and the Genocide Memorial require strict no-photography compliance.
Advisory Level	1 — Exercise Normal Precautions (one of the safest countries in Africa)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Plastic bag ban — enforced at airport customs. Bags will be confiscated
- Homosexuality is not explicitly criminalised but LGBTQ+ travellers should exercise discretion
- Drug offences carry heavy penalties including lengthy imprisonment
- Criticising the government or President publicly can result in arrest

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever (if arriving from an endemic country)

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Rabies (for extended rural stays)
- Meningitis
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (present year-round, especially in lower altitude areas)
- Cholera (periodic outbreaks)
- Typhoid
- Bilharzia (schistosomiasis) in Lake Kivu

Active Outbreaks	Monitor CDC and WHO for Ebola updates — Democratic Republic of Congo border area
Malaria Prophylaxis	Recommended — consult a travel doctor for the right antimalarial medication
Medication Rules	Carry a copy of all prescriptions. Antimalarials and most travel medications available in Kigali pharmacies.
Water Safety	Drink bottled or boiled water only. Tap water in Kigali is treated but bottled water is safer for visitors.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/rwanda

🇰🇪 KENYA (KE)

East Africa · Capital: Nairobi

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — eTA required for most nationalities (replaced visa system in 2024)
Visa Type	Electronic Travel Authorisation (eTA)
eVisa Portal	https://etakenya.go.ke
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	90 days
Visa-Free Access	East African Community citizens. Citizens of some Commonwealth countries.
Entry Rules	eTA must be obtained before travel. Return/onward ticket required. Yellow Fever certificate if arriving from endemic country.
Visa Duration	Up to 90 days per visit
Cost	USD 30 per person
Processing Time	eTA approved within 72 hours (usually faster)
Official Source	https://etakenya.go.ke

🚨 EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
999 or 112	**999 or 112**	**999 or 112**	**112**	**(+254) 20 604 767**

Tourist Police	(+254) 20 604 767
US Embassy	(+254) 20 363 6000
UK Embassy	(+254) 20 284 4000
Notes	999 works on all networks. 112 works even without airtime. Tourist police have a 24-hour hotline.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Obtain your eTA at https://etakenya.go.ke before flying — airlines will deny boarding without it
- Carry a printed or digital copy of your eTA confirmation at all times
- Use registered taxis or Uber/Bolt in Nairobi — do not hail unmarked vehicles
- Bargain respectfully at markets — haggling is expected and considered part of the culture
- Respect wildlife at all times in national parks — keep inside vehicles and maintain safe distances
- Dress modestly when visiting mosques, especially along the coast (Mombasa, Lamu)
- Greet people in Swahili — 'Jambo' (hello) and 'Asante' (thank you) are warmly received

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT travel to border areas with Somalia, South Sudan, or Ethiopia without specific security advice
- Do NOT photograph police officers, military personnel, or government buildings without permission
- Do NOT use plastic bags — banned nationwide since 2017, fines up to KES 4 million
- Do NOT feed or approach wildlife in national parks
- Do NOT accept rides from strangers or unlicensed vehicles, especially at night
- Do NOT carry or use recreational drugs — severe penalties apply
- Do NOT drink tap water outside of major hotels — use bottled water

Dress Code	Casual in Nairobi and major cities. Modest dress (covered arms and legs) required in coastal Muslim areas and when visiting mosques. Safari-appropriate neutral colours recommended in national parks.
Photography Rules	Ask permission before photographing people — many communities charge a small fee. No photography of police, military, airports, or government buildings. In national parks, photography of wildlife is encouraged but flash photography near animals is prohibited.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (crime in urban areas; terrorism risk in border regions)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Plastic bag ban is strictly enforced — importing or using plastic bags can result in fines or arrest
- Same-sex relationships are criminalised — LGBTQ+ travellers should exercise extreme caution
- Wildlife trafficking carries a minimum 5-year prison sentence
- Corruption: do not offer bribes to police officers — it is illegal and increasingly prosecuted

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever (if arriving from an endemic country — proof required at entry)

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Cholera
- Rabies (for rural/wildlife areas)
- Meningitis
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk in coast and lake regions year-round)
- Dengue Fever (coastal areas)
- Cholera (periodic outbreaks)
- Rift Valley Fever (rare)
- Plague (rare, North Eastern Province)

Active Outbreaks	Monitor CDC for Dengue and Cholera seasonal notices
Malaria Prophylaxis	Strongly recommended for all visitors, especially to Mombasa, Kisumu, and safari areas
Medication Rules	Carry prescriptions for all medications. Antimalarials available in major pharmacies. Bring sufficient supply of any specialist medications.
Water Safety	Do not drink tap water. Use sealed bottled water. Ice in restaurants may be unsafe outside major hotels.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/kenya

🇹🇿 TANZANIA (TZ)

East Africa · Capital: Dodoma (commercial: Dar es Salaam)

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — eVisa required for most nationalities
Visa Type	eVisa (online application)
eVisa Portal	https://eservices.immigration.go.tz
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	90 days
Visa-Free Access	East African Community citizens. Some reciprocal arrangements.
Entry Rules	eVisa must be obtained before travel. Yellow Fever certificate required from endemic countries. Return ticket required.
Visa Duration	Single entry: 90 days. Multiple entry available.
Cost	USD 50 single entry
Processing Time	3–5 business days
Official Source	https://eservices.immigration.go.tz

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
112 or 999	**112**	**114**	**112**	**(+255) 22 211 5047**

Tourist Police	(+255) 22 211 5047
US Embassy	(+255) 22 229 4000
UK Embassy	(+255) 22 229 0000
Notes	112 is the main emergency number. Response times can vary outside Dar es Salaam and Zanzibar.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Apply for your eVisa well in advance at https://eservices.immigration.go.tz
- Dress very modestly in Zanzibar and all Muslim communities — this is strongly expected
- Remove shoes before entering mosques and some traditional homes
- Greet locals with 'Habari' (how are you) — Tanzanians appreciate Swahili greetings from visitors
- Book safaris and Kilimanjaro climbs through licensed operators only
- Carry cash (Tanzanian Shilling or USD) in rural areas — card acceptance is limited
- Respect local customs around photography — always ask first

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT display affection publicly, especially in Zanzibar — it is considered offensive
- Do NOT photograph without permission — especially in Muslim communities
- Do NOT bring or use plastic bags — banned nationwide
- Do NOT attempt to climb Kilimanjaro without a licensed guide — it is illegal and dangerous
- Do NOT travel to the Mozambique border area without current security advice
- Do NOT buy, sell, or transport ivory or wildlife products — severe prison sentences apply
- Do NOT drink tap water — bottled water is essential throughout Tanzania

Dress Code	Conservative dress is essential across Tanzania. In Zanzibar, women should cover shoulders and knees even on the street. Men should avoid sleeveless tops outside beach areas. Swimwear is only acceptable at beach resorts and hotel pools.
Photography Rules	Photography of people requires explicit permission. Government buildings, military installations, airports, and border crossings are strictly off-limits. National park wildlife photography is encouraged but no drones without a permit.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (terrorism risk in border areas; crime in Dar es Salaam)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Same-sex relationships are criminalised with up to 30 years imprisonment — exercise extreme caution
- Wildlife trafficking: mandatory minimum 20-year sentence for ivory or rhino horn possession
- Drug offences carry life imprisonment or death penalty in serious cases
- Zanzibar has its own laws and cultural expectations more conservative than mainland Tanzania

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever (required from endemic countries — certificate checked at entry)

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Rabies
- Cholera
- Meningitis
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk year-round across most of Tanzania)
- Cholera (periodic outbreaks especially in rainy seasons)
- Dengue Fever
- Bilharzia (in lake and river areas)
- Plague (rare, northern highlands)

Active Outbreaks	Monitor WHO/CDC for seasonal Cholera alerts during rainy season (March–May, October–December)
Malaria Prophylaxis	Strongly recommended for all regions including Zanzibar
Medication Rules	Bring full supply of prescription medications — specialist drugs may not be available outside Dar es Salaam. Carry prescriptions in original packaging.
Water Safety	Tap water is unsafe throughout Tanzania including Zanzibar. Use sealed bottled water exclusively.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/tanzania

🇺🇬 UGANDA (UG)

East Africa · Capital: Kampala

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — eVisa required for most nationalities
Visa Type	eVisa (online) or East Africa Tourist Visa (shared with Kenya & Rwanda)
eVisa Portal	https://visas.immigration.go.ug
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	90 days
Visa-Free Access	East African Community citizens. Some Commonwealth countries.
Entry Rules	eVisa required before travel. Yellow Fever vaccination certificate mandatory for all travellers.
Visa Duration	Single entry: 90 days. East Africa Tourist Visa covers Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda.
Cost	USD 50 single entry / East Africa Tourist Visa: USD 100
Processing Time	3–5 business days
Official Source	https://visas.immigration.go.ug

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
999 or 112	**999 or 112**	**999 or 112**	**112**	**(+256) 414 233 222**

Tourist Police	(+256) 414 233 222
US Embassy	(+256) 414 259 791
UK Embassy	(+256) 312 312 000
Notes	Yellow Fever certificate is MANDATORY for all travellers — not just those from endemic countries. You will be turned away without it.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Get your Yellow Fever vaccination and carry the physical certificate — it is checked at entry
- Apply for the East Africa Tourist Visa if visiting Kenya and Rwanda in the same trip — saves money
- Dress modestly, especially in rural areas and when visiting religious sites
- Ask permission before photographing people — especially in traditional communities and near Bwindi forest
- Book gorilla trekking permits well in advance through the Uganda Wildlife Authority
- Use registered boda-bodas (motorcycle taxis) and always wear the provided helmet
- Exchange money at banks or authorised forex bureaux — street exchange is risky

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT enter Uganda without a Yellow Fever certificate — entry will be refused
- Do NOT photograph the President's residence, military, or government buildings
- Do NOT travel to the Democratic Republic of Congo border without current security advice
- Do NOT engage in any same-sex conduct — it is criminalised with severe penalties
- Do NOT purchase or possess wildlife products including gorilla souvenirs
- Do NOT use plastic bags — banned
- Do NOT drink tap water — use bottled water throughout Uganda

Dress Code	Modest dress required across Uganda. Covering shoulders and knees is expected in rural areas, churches, and mosques. Kampala is relatively relaxed but conservative dress shows respect. Swimwear only at hotel pools and lakeside resorts.
Photography Rules	Always ask permission before photographing individuals and communities. Gorilla photography is allowed on treks but no flash. Military, government buildings, and Entebbe International Airport are strictly no-photography zones.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (terrorism risk near DRC and South Sudan borders; crime in Kampala)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- The Anti-Homosexuality Act (2023) imposes severe penalties including the death penalty in some cases — LGBTQ+ travellers face serious risk
- Yellow Fever certificate is a legal entry requirement — not optional
- Drug trafficking carries the death penalty
- Bribery of officials is illegal — do not offer money to police or border officers

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever — MANDATORY for ALL travellers regardless of origin country

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Rabies (especially for wildlife areas)
- Meningitis
- Cholera
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk year-round across all regions)
- Ebola (monitoring — DRC border proximity)
- Cholera
- Plague (rare)

- Marburg Virus (rare, historical outbreaks in western Uganda)

Active Outbreaks	Monitor WHO/CDC for Ebola alerts — DRC border area carries ongoing risk
Malaria Prophylaxis	Strongly recommended for all visitors. Mosquito repellent and bed nets also essential.
Medication Rules	Bring all medications from home — specialist drugs unavailable outside Kampala. Antimalarials widely available in Kampala pharmacies.
Water Safety	Do not drink tap water anywhere in Uganda. Use sealed bottled water. Avoid ice in drinks outside major hotels.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/uganda

🇳🇬 NIGERIA (NG)

West Africa · Capital: Abuja

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — visa required for most nationalities
Visa Type	eVisa (online) or visa on arrival for eligible countries
eVisa Portal	https://immigration.gov.ng/visa-on-arrival/
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	90 days (varies by visa category)
Visa-Free Access	ECOWAS (Economic Community of West African States) citizens — 90 days visa-free
Entry Rules	Proof of return/onward travel. Sufficient funds. Yellow Fever certificate mandatory.
Visa Duration	30–90 days depending on visa type
Cost	Varies by nationality — check Nigerian Immigration Service website
Processing Time	5–10 business days for standard; visa on arrival also available at Lagos and Abuja airports
Official Source	https://immigration.gov.ng

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
199 or 112	**199 or 112**	**199 or 112**	**112**	**(+234) 803 309 2194**

Tourist Police	(+234) 803 309 2194
US Embassy	(+234) 9 461 4000 (Abuja)
UK Embassy	(+234) 1 277 0780 (Lagos)
Notes	Emergency services response times vary significantly. Private security and medical evacuation services are recommended for business travellers.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Register your arrival with your country's embassy or high commission in Nigeria
- Use only reputable hotels with security — avoid budget accommodation in unfamiliar areas
- Hire a trusted local guide or driver — locals know which areas are safe
- Carry Yellow Fever certificate at all times — checked at airports and sometimes inland
- Use ATMs inside banks or hotels — street ATMs have higher skimming risk
- Respect Islamic customs and prayer times in northern Nigeria

- Keep valuables secured and avoid displaying expensive items in public

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT travel to northeast Nigeria (Borno, Yobe, Adamawa states) — active Boko Haram/ISWAP operations
- Do NOT travel to the Niger Delta without specific security clearance
- Do NOT accept drinks or food from strangers — drug-facilitated robbery ('knockout drops') is reported
- Do NOT photograph airports, military installations, or government buildings
- Do NOT use unregistered 'yellow bus' or motorcycle taxis in Lagos
- Do NOT engage in cryptocurrency or advance-fee fraud schemes — frequently used to target visitors
- Do NOT travel at night by road between cities — armed robbery is a risk on intercity highways

Dress Code	Business casual to smart in Lagos and Abuja. Conservative dress in northern (predominantly Muslim) states — women should cover hair, arms, and legs in public. Traditional dress (agbada, dashiki) is welcomed and appreciated at cultural events.
Photography Rules	No photography of military, police, government buildings, airports, or oil installations. Photography of people in markets and cultural events is generally acceptable but ask first. Photography in slum areas may attract hostility.
Advisory Level	3 — Reconsider Travel (terrorism in northeast; kidnapping; crime; civil unrest in some regions)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Same-sex relationships are criminalised — penalty up to 14 years imprisonment in southern states; death by stoning in some northern states under Sharia law
- Drug trafficking carries the death penalty
- Cybercrime laws are broadly worded — be careful about social media posts critical of the government
- Currency regulations: declare large amounts of foreign currency at entry

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever — MANDATORY for all travellers entering Nigeria

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Meningitis (especially for northern regions)
- Rabies
- Cholera
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk year-round nationwide)
- Lassa Fever (endemic, especially in rural areas)

- Cholera (periodic outbreaks)
- Monkeypox (endemic)
- Meningitis (northern belt, dry season)
- Dengue Fever

Active Outbreaks	Monitor CDC/WHO for Lassa Fever and Cholera outbreak alerts — seasonal peaks February–May
Malaria Prophylaxis	Essential for all visitors. Nigeria has one of the world's highest malaria burdens.
Medication Rules	Carry prescriptions for all medications. Counterfeit medications are a known problem in local pharmacies — use reputable pharmacies in major hospitals.
Water Safety	Tap water is unsafe throughout Nigeria. Use sealed bottled water exclusively. Avoid ice and raw food washed with tap water.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/nigeria

🇬🇭 GHANA (GH)

West Africa · Capital: Accra

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — visa required for most non-ECOWAS nationalities
Visa Type	eVisa (online application) or visa on arrival for eligible nationals
eVisa Portal	https://evisa.gov.gh
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	60 days (extendable)
Visa-Free Access	ECOWAS citizens — 90 days visa-free
Entry Rules	Return/onward ticket required. Yellow Fever certificate mandatory. eVisa recommended over visa on arrival.
Visa Duration	60 days single entry; multiple entry options available
Cost	USD 30–50 depending on nationality
Processing Time	2–5 business days
Official Source	https://evisa.gov.gh

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
191 or 112	**193 or 112**	**192 or 112**	**112**	**(+233) 30 222 3355**

Tourist Police	(+233) 30 222 3355
US Embassy	(+233) 30 274 1000
UK Embassy	(+233) 30 221 3250
Notes	Ghana has relatively reliable emergency services in Accra and Kumasi. Tourist police are active in major tourist areas.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Ghana is one of West Africa's most stable and tourist-friendly countries — enjoy it with normal precautions
- Use the official eVisa portal before travelling — visa on arrival is possible but eVisa is smoother
- Carry your Yellow Fever certificate — checked at entry
- Greet people warmly — Ghanaians are known for their friendliness and appreciate polite interaction
- Use the right hand or both hands when giving, receiving, or greeting — left hand alone is impolite
- Bargain respectfully at local markets — it is culturally expected
- Visit Cape Coast Castle with respect — it is a deeply significant historical and memorial site

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT use your left hand alone to eat, give, or receive — it is culturally disrespectful
- Do NOT photograph military installations, police stations, or government buildings without permission
- Do NOT travel to the northern border regions with Burkina Faso without current security advice — terrorism spill-over risk
- Do NOT buy or sell wildlife products
- Do NOT carry or use drugs — penalties are severe
- Do NOT drink tap water — use bottled water
- Do NOT leave valuables unattended on beaches in Accra

Dress Code	Casual but respectful in Accra and coastal areas. Conservative dress in Muslim northern regions. Traditional kente cloth is culturally significant — wearing it as a tourist at cultural events is welcomed. Beach attire only at beach resorts.
Photography Rules	Photography is generally welcomed in Ghana. Always ask permission for portraits. No photography of military, police, government buildings, or airports. At cultural ceremonies and funerals, ask the chief or family before photographing.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (crime in Accra; terrorism risk in northern border areas)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Same-sex relationships are illegal — the Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Act (2024) significantly increased penalties
- Drug offences carry minimum 5-year imprisonment
- Cybercrime laws prohibit spreading 'false news' — be careful with social media content
- Export of undeclared antiques or cultural artefacts is prohibited

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever — MANDATORY for all travellers

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Meningitis
- Rabies
- Cholera
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk year-round — one of the most malaria-endemic countries in West Africa)
- Typhoid
- Hepatitis A
- Cholera (periodic outbreaks)

- Dengue Fever (emerging risk)

Active Outbreaks	Monitor CDC/WHO for Meningitis belt alerts (dry season, November–May) in northern regions
Malaria Prophylaxis	Strongly recommended for all visitors. Use mosquito repellent and sleep under nets.
Medication Rules	Bring full supply of all medications. Antimalarials available in Accra pharmacies. Counterfeit drugs present in street markets — use hospital pharmacies.
Water Safety	Tap water is unsafe. Drink sealed bottled water only. Sachet water ('pure water') sold on streets is generally unsafe for visitors.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/ghana

🇿🇦 SOUTH AFRICA (ZA)

Southern Africa · Capital: Pretoria (Cape Town: legislative)

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	No — most nationalities get 90 days visa-free on arrival
Visa Type	Visa-free entry for most Western, EU, and Commonwealth passport holders
eVisa Portal	https://www.vfsglobal.com/southafrica (for nationalities that require a visa)
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 30 days beyond intended departure date AND have at least 2 blank pages
Maximum Stay	90 days (for visa-free nationalities)
Visa-Free Access	USA, UK, EU, Australia, Canada, most African Union countries — check DHA list
Entry Rules	Proof of onward/return travel. Sufficient funds. Minors must carry full birth certificate (and parental consent if travelling with one parent or alone).
Visa Duration	90 days visa-free for most; extendable in-country
Cost	Free for visa-exempt nationalities
Processing Time	N/A for visa-free; 5–10 days for visa applicants
Official Source	https://www.dha.gov.za

🚨 EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
10111 or 112	**10177 or 112**	**10177 or 112**	**112**	**0860 010 111 (South African Tourism Safety)**

Tourist Police	0860 010 111 (South African Tourism Safety)
US Embassy	(+27) 12 431 4000
UK Embassy	(+27) 12 421 7500
Notes	112 works from any mobile phone including without airtime. Cape Town, Johannesburg, and Durban have dedicated tourist police units.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Be very security-conscious — South Africa has high crime rates in urban areas
- Use e-hailing apps (Uber, Bolt) rather than hailing taxis on the street in cities
- Keep car doors locked and windows up when driving in cities, especially at traffic lights
- Store valuables in hotel safes — do not leave anything visible in parked cars
- Carry copies of your passport and visa — leave originals in the hotel safe

- Visit national parks (Kruger, Table Mountain, Garden Route) — world-class wildlife experiences
- Tip service staff 10–15% — it is expected and forms a significant part of their income

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT walk alone at night in Johannesburg CBD, Cape Town CBD, or Durban beachfront
- Do NOT display expensive jewellery, cameras, or phones in public
- Do NOT stop for strangers gesturing about car trouble on highways — a common robbery technique
- Do NOT exchange money on the street
- Do NOT drink and drive — zero tolerance enforced
- Do NOT approach wildlife in game reserves on foot without a licensed ranger
- Do NOT travel to Cape Flats, Alexandra, Hillbrow (Johannesburg), or Umlazi (Durban) without a local guide

Dress Code	South Africa is relaxed and cosmopolitan. Business casual in Johannesburg and Cape Town CBD. Beach attire at coastal areas. Smart casual for restaurants and entertainment venues. Conservative dress when visiting traditional Zulu, Xhosa, or other cultural communities.
Photography Rules	Photography widely accepted. Ask permission for portraits of individuals. No photography inside parliament buildings or at military installations. Township photography: always use a guide who has community relationships — unannounced photography can cause hostility.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (crime; carjacking; home invasion; load shedding infrastructure disruptions)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Same-sex relationships are legal and constitutional rights are protected — South Africa is the most LGBTQ+ inclusive country on the continent
- Cannabis is decriminalised for personal use in private — but public use and sale remain illegal
- Road safety: South Africa has one of the world's highest road fatality rates — drive defensively
- Minors travelling rule: children under 18 MUST carry their full birth certificate at all times

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever (only if arriving from a Yellow Fever endemic country — certificate checked)

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Rabies (for rural/wildlife areas)
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- HIV/AIDS (very high prevalence — take universal precautions)
- Malaria (risk in Limpopo, Mpumalanga, northern KwaZulu-Natal — NOT in Cape Town or Johannesburg)

- Tuberculosis (high prevalence)
- Bilharzia (freshwater lakes and rivers)

Active Outbreaks	Malaria risk is seasonal — highest October–May in northern provinces
Malaria Prophylaxis	Required only if visiting Kruger National Park, Limpopo, or Mpumalanga. Not needed for Cape Town, Johannesburg, or Garden Route.
Medication Rules	Full range of medications available in South Africa. Major pharmacy chains (Clicks, Dis-Chem) in all cities. Prescriptions required for controlled substances.
Water Safety	Tap water is generally safe to drink in major cities. In rural areas and during droughts, use bottled water. Cape Town tap water is excellent quality.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/south-africa

🇲🇦 MOROCCO (MA)

North Africa · Capital: Rabat

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	No — most nationalities receive 90 days visa-free on arrival
Visa Type	Visa-free entry stamp on arrival
eVisa Portal	N/A for visa-free nationalities — entry stamp given at port of entry
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	90 days
Visa-Free Access	USA, UK, EU, Australia, Canada and most countries — check MAEG list
Entry Rules	Return/onward ticket. Sufficient funds. Accommodation proof may be requested.
Visa Duration	90 days
Cost	Free for visa-exempt nationalities
Processing Time	N/A — entry stamp at airport
Official Source	https://www.diplomatie.ma

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
19 or 112	**15 or 112**	**15 or 112**	**112**	**(+212) 5224-84601 (Brigade Touristique)**

Tourist Police	(+212) 5224-84601 (Brigade Touristique)
US Embassy	(+212) 5 37 63 33 33 (Rabat)
UK Embassy	(+212) 5 37 63 33 33 (Rabat)
Notes	Morocco has a dedicated tourist police (Brigade Touristique) in all major tourist cities including Marrakech, Fes, Agadir, and Casablanca.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Dress modestly — Morocco is a Muslim-majority country and conservative dress is respected especially in medinas
- Accept mint tea when offered — refusing hospitality is considered impolite
- Bargain in souks (markets) — it is expected and part of the shopping experience
- Learn a few basic French or Darija (Moroccan Arabic) phrases — locals appreciate the effort
- Respect prayer times — businesses may close briefly during the 5 daily prayers

- Use licensed guides in medinas — unofficial 'guides' often lead to commission shops
- Visit the hammam (traditional bathhouse) — a genuine cultural experience

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT display public affection (kissing, hugging) between couples — illegal in public and will cause offence
- Do NOT eat, drink, or smoke in public during Ramadan daylight hours — it is illegal and deeply disrespectful
- Do NOT photograph people without permission — especially women in medinas
- Do NOT accept invitations to private homes from strangers in tourist areas — common scam
- Do NOT buy or sell kif (cannabis) — widely grown but illegal for tourists
- Do NOT wear revealing clothing in medinas, mosques or rural areas
- Do NOT enter mosques unless they are specifically open to non-Muslims

Dress Code	Women should cover shoulders and knees in medinas, markets, and rural areas. Head covering recommended in mosques. Men should avoid shorts in religious areas. Beachwear is acceptable only at beach resorts in Agadir and Essaouira.
Photography Rules	Always ask before photographing people — many will ask for payment. Photographing military, royal palaces, and government buildings is illegal. Morocco's architecture, landscapes, and markets are very photogenic — just be respectful.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (terrorism risk; petty crime in tourist areas)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Public displays of affection are illegal between unmarried couples
- Eating/drinking in public during Ramadan is illegal and can result in arrest
- Same-sex relationships are criminalised — up to 3 years imprisonment
- Cannabis possession is illegal regardless of amounts grown in the Rif region
- Criticising the King or the royal family is a serious criminal offence

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- None required for entry from most countries

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Rabies (for rural areas)
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Typhoid (food and water-borne)
- Hepatitis A
- Rabies (from stray dogs and cats — very common)
- Leishmaniasis (sandfly-borne, rural areas)

- Scorpion and snake bites (desert/rural areas)

Active Outbreaks	No major ongoing outbreaks. Monitor CDC for any seasonal notices.
Malaria Prophylaxis	Not required. Malaria is not present in Morocco.
Medication Rules	Good range of medications available in Moroccan pharmacies (pharmacies identified by green cross). Prescriptions required for antibiotics and controlled medications.
Water Safety	Tap water in cities is technically treated but bottled water is strongly recommended for visitors. In rural and desert areas, bottled water is essential.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/morocco

🇪🇹 ETHIOPIA (ET)

East Africa · Capital: Addis Ababa

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	Yes — eVisa required for most nationalities
Visa Type	eVisa (online application)
eVisa Portal	https://www.evisa.gov.et
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	30 days (single entry) or 90 days (multiple entry)
Visa-Free Access	African Union passport holders and some other African countries
Entry Rules	eVisa must be obtained before travel. Yellow Fever certificate required from endemic countries. Return ticket required.
Visa Duration	30 or 90 days depending on application type
Cost	USD 52 single entry
Processing Time	3 business days
Official Source	https://www.evisa.gov.et

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
991 or 112	**907 or 112**	**939 or 112**	**991**	**(+251) 11 551 7788**

Tourist Police	(+251) 11 551 7788
US Embassy	(+251) 11 130 6000
UK Embassy	(+251) 11 617 0100
Notes	Emergency service response capacity is limited outside Addis Ababa. Carry emergency contacts for medical evacuation services if travelling to remote areas.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Apply for your eVisa well in advance at https://www.evisa.gov.et — allow at least 1 week
- Carry your Yellow Fever certificate if arriving from an endemic country
- Dress conservatively, especially when visiting Orthodox Christian churches and monasteries
- Remove shoes when entering churches and mosques — this is mandatory
- Respect religious fasting periods — many restaurants modify menus during Orthodox fasting days
- Register with your embassy upon arrival if staying for more than 1 week
- Use authorised forex offices or banks to exchange currency — unofficial exchanges are illegal

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT travel to Tigray, Afar, Amhara, and Somali regions without current security clearance — active conflict and instability
- Do NOT photograph military installations, government buildings, airports, or defence infrastructure
- Do NOT photograph people without permission — especially in traditional communities
- Do NOT travel by road at night outside Addis Ababa
- Do NOT engage in any political discussions or demonstrations
- Do NOT drink tap water anywhere in Ethiopia — use bottled water
- Do NOT carry or use drugs — severe penalties apply

Dress Code	Conservative dress is essential throughout Ethiopia. Women should cover hair, shoulders, and knees when visiting Orthodox churches and mosques. Men should wear long trousers in religious sites. Addis Ababa is more relaxed but modest dress is always appropriate.
Photography Rules	Photography of the historic sites (Lalibela, Axum, Gondar) is permitted with a photography permit available on site. Military, airports, government buildings, and border areas are strictly prohibited. Always ask before photographing people — some communities strongly object.
Advisory Level	3 — Reconsider Travel (active armed conflict in northern regions; terrorism risk near Somali border; civil unrest)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Travel to conflict zones (Tigray, parts of Amhara and Afar) is extremely dangerous — do not travel
- Same-sex relationships are criminalised — up to 15 years imprisonment
- Anti-terrorism law is broadly worded — journalists and researchers should seek legal advice
- Currency regulations: do not exchange money on the black market — illegal and risky

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever (required if arriving from endemic country — certificate checked at entry)

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Meningitis
- Rabies
- Cholera
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk in lowlands — not present in Addis Ababa at 2,355m altitude)
- Typhoid
- Cholera (periodic outbreaks)

- Hepatitis A
- Leishmaniasis (rural areas)
- Rabies (from dogs)

Active Outbreaks	Monitor CDC/WHO for Cholera alerts. Conflict regions have elevated disease risk from population displacement.
Malaria Prophylaxis	Required for all regions below 2,000m altitude. Addis Ababa is malaria-free due to high altitude.
Medication Rules	Bring full supply of all medications from home. Limited pharmaceutical availability outside Addis Ababa. Antimalarials available in the capital.
Water Safety	Tap water is unsafe throughout Ethiopia. Use sealed bottled water exclusively, including in Addis Ababa. Never use ice from unknown sources.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/ethiopia

🇸🇳 SENEGAL (SN)

West Africa · Capital: Dakar

VISA REQUIREMENTS

Visa Required	No — most nationalities receive 90 days visa-free
Visa Type	Visa-free entry for most Western, EU, and many African nationals
eVisa Portal	https://visas.diplomatie.sn (for nationalities that require a visa)
Passport Validity	Must be valid for at least 6 months beyond entry date
Maximum Stay	90 days
Visa-Free Access	USA, UK, EU, Australia, Canada, ECOWAS citizens — one of the most open visa policies in West Africa
Entry Rules	Return/onward ticket. Sufficient funds. Yellow Fever certificate required.
Visa Duration	90 days visa-free
Cost	Free for visa-exempt nationalities
Processing Time	N/A — entry stamp on arrival
Official Source	https://www.diplomatie.sn

EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Police	Ambulance	Fire	General Emergency	Tourist Police
17 or 112	**15 or 112**	**18 or 112**	**112**	**(+221) 33 869 2232**

Tourist Police	(+221) 33 869 2232
US Embassy	(+221) 33 879 4000
UK Embassy	(+221) 33 823 7392
Notes	Senegal has a relatively reliable emergency service in Dakar. Tourist police are active in Dakar and Saint-Louis. French is the working language for emergency services.

TRAVEL DOS & DON'TS

THINGS TO DO

- Carry your Yellow Fever certificate — mandatory for all travellers entering Senegal
- Learn a few words in Wolof or French — 'Jërejëf' (thank you in Wolof) is warmly appreciated
- Accept hospitality warmly — Senegalese culture ('Teranga') is built on legendary generosity to guests
- Dress modestly when visiting mosques and in rural communities
- Use authorised money changers or banks — street exchange is risky
- Visit Goree Island — a historically significant and moving UNESCO World Heritage Site

- Bargain respectfully in markets — it is expected and culturally normal

THINGS TO AVOID

- Do NOT enter a mosque without being invited or welcomed in — non-Muslims should wait to be invited
- Do NOT eat with your left hand — considered disrespectful
- Do NOT travel to the Casamance region in the south without current security advice — historical separatist tensions
- Do NOT photograph military, police, or government buildings without permission
- Do NOT drink tap water — use bottled water
- Do NOT carry or use drugs — severe penalties apply
- Do NOT display excessive wealth or flash expensive items in public in Dakar

Dress Code	Modest dress throughout Senegal. Women should cover shoulders and knees, especially outside beach areas. Men should avoid sleeveless tops in non-beach settings. During Tabaski and Korité (major Islamic holidays) smart and conservative dress is strongly expected. Swimwear only at designated beach resorts.
Photography Rules	Photography is generally welcomed in Senegal. Always ask permission before photographing individuals. Goree Island — photography is permitted and encouraged. Military and government buildings require permission. At religious sites, ask the imam or caretaker first.
Advisory Level	2 — Exercise High Degree of Caution (crime in Dakar; instability in Casamance region)

LEGAL WARNINGS

- Same-sex relationships are criminalised — up to 5 years imprisonment
- Drug offences carry minimum 2-year imprisonment
- Photographing the Presidential Palace or military is illegal
- Casamance region has unexploded landmines in some rural areas — stick to known paths

HEALTH ADVISORIES

REQUIRED VACCINES (mandatory for entry)

- Yellow Fever — MANDATORY for all travellers

RECOMMENDED VACCINES

- Hepatitis A
- Hepatitis B
- Typhoid
- Meningitis
- Rabies
- Cholera
- Routine vaccinations (MMR, Tetanus, Polio)

HEALTH RISKS AT DESTINATION

- Malaria (high risk year-round — especially during and after rainy season June–October)
- Dengue Fever (increasing reports)
- Cholera (periodic outbreaks, especially post-rainy season)
- Typhoid
- Bilharzia (freshwater exposure)

Active Outbreaks	Monitor CDC/WHO for Dengue and Cholera alerts — peak risk July–November
Malaria Prophylaxis	Strongly recommended for all visitors year-round. Mosquito repellent (DEET-based) and bed nets are essential.
Medication Rules	Antimalarials and basic medications available in Dakar pharmacies. Bring specialist medications from home — limited availability outside the capital.
Water Safety	Tap water is unsafe throughout Senegal. Use sealed bottled water only. Avoid ice, raw salads, and street food prepared with tap water.
CDC Reference Page	https://wwwnc.cdc.gov/travel/destinations/traveler/none/senegal